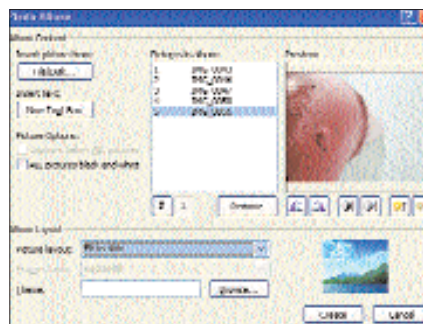


 **Create Photo Albums with PowerPoint**

Creating photo albums can become a dilemma for some of us. PowerPoint 2007 has a feature that lets you create a photo slideshow within seconds. First click on the **Insert** tab in the ribbon. Click the **Photo Album** icon and choose **New**



Creating photo albums in PowerPoint to show your friends

Photo Album. Click the **File/Disk** button to add images to the album. Select the photos you want in the sideshow and click **Insert**. You can use the **Up** and **Down** arrows here to change the order of the photos. You can also alter the brightness, contrast, and orientation of the images. When you're done, click the **Create** button and your Photo Album is ready. You can now continue adding notes to each slide.

Recording Narrations

PowerPoint lets you record a

To record a narration, first click the **Slide Show** tab in the ribbon. Click the **Record Narration** icon. Here you have the option to change the microphone volume, quality, and where the file should be saved. Click **OK** once you're done with the changes. Click the **Current Slide** button if you want to record a voiceover starting from the



Record voice-overs for presentations for events you can't be present at

current slide, or click the **First Slide** button if you want to start from the very beginning. The slideshow will then start and you can start speaking into the microphone. Click to switch to the next slide and continue speaking as necessary. When all the slides are done, you'll be asked whether you want to save the timings for each slide. Click **Save**.

 Quickly Apply Transition Effects

Transition effects for slides can be quickly accessed through the ribbon

Little visual details like transition effects can make presentations stand out. With older versions of PowerPoint, you were required to right-click on a slide, click on **Slide Transition**, and then choose from a list of effects from a sidebar.

In PowerPoint 2007, click the Animations tab in the ribbon. You will find a list of transition effects displayed

PowerPoint 2007 also gives you other options like the ability to change or set sounds, timings, and speeds for the effect.

 Accurate Placement

 Placing elements and then aligning them or accurately placing them can be a little irritating, but is worth the effort. Click the object and use the direction keys to move them into place. Holding down [Ctrl] while you do this gives you pixel-accurate movement, which means you can move them even more closely and even more perfectly. Don't forget to use gridlines to align objects better—under the View tab, check the box against Gridlines.

Formatting Images

 Previous Office versions would also let you do some changes to the images in your presentations but in a rather non-interactive manner. The new PowerPoint 2007 shows you live previews after every change made.

Click on an Image and click the **Format** tab that appears in the ribbon. Here a wide range of settings such as Picture Styles, Brightness, Contrast, and Colour parameters can be modified. Move your mouse over any of the styles and the preview will be shown on the image right in the slide.

Using SmartArt

 SmartArt are designs and shapes to be used in presentations. The specialty with these is that their colours change to suit the theme you use for the presentation, so you don't have to worry about them individually.

Go to the **Insert** tab on the Ribbon and then select the **SmartArt** icon. A wide variety can be found here. The same goes for **Shapes** tool—their colours change accordingly as well.

 Disable Image Compression

 By default, PowerPoint 2007 compresses images put into a presentation while saving. While this saves file size, it can result in a loss of quality—which you might not always want.

To disable compression, select the Office Button > Save As. Then select Tools > Compress Pictures. Click Options. Uncheck the box against Automatically perform basic compression on Save. You can also change the density (pixels per inch) of